

My Uncertainty & ERP Practice

Original worksheet by Sophia Cohon, PhD

Choose one practice with your clinician. Let the plan guide the action.

Doubt / trigger

The familiar loop

Check · ask · replay



Brief relief



↻ Doubt returns

A route to practice

Allow doubt to be here



Leave the ritual undone



Return to a chosen activity

Trigger / situation I will practice with

What OCD says I need to settle

The ritual I am working on

☐ Checking

☐ Asking for reassurance

☐ Searching / researching

☐ Repeating / redoing

☐ Replaying in my mind

☐ Avoiding

My agreed practice

Approach this situation

Leave this ritual undone

Continue this activity

When / how long, as agreed with my clinician

Support that helps me continue without reassurance

Success can include feeling uncertain. The goal is to practice the agreed action without the ritual, rather than wait for a calm feeling or a guarantee.

What I did with the urge

What I learned / next practice

Plan with an OCD-trained clinician

Exposure and response prevention (ERP) pairs approaching an agreed trigger with leaving a compulsion undone. Choose one specific target, a manageable practice, and a clear response-prevention plan together.

What I want more room for in my life

Hidden rituals or workarounds to notice

Support without solving the doubt

A helper can be present, remind you of your plan, or help you return to a chosen activity. Repeated promises, searching for proof, or reviewing until it feels certain may become another ritual.

What my helper and I agree to do when I ask for certainty

Review the practice

Did I skip, delay, or substitute the target ritual?

What should we repeat or adjust?

Keep real safety and consent. Do not use exposure to override actual danger, medical needs, trauma boundaries, or the person's choice. Comfort, access needs, and sensory supports are not automatically compulsions; clarify their purpose with the clinician.

About this worksheet. This original planning tool summarizes the guidance linked below. It is not a validated assessment or a copy of an external worksheet. Guidance checked September 29, 2026.

- [International OCD Foundation: exposure and response prevention](#)
- [International OCD Foundation: ERP treatment guide](#)